

Component 1	Component 2
Student completes as a performer or designer	Student studies one extract as a designer and the second extract as a performer (or vice versa)

Component 1: Devising

Overview

This component deals with devising, which is an exciting and challenging opportunity to work collaboratively with others to explore a range of stimuli in order to create an original performance piece.

Devising is essential for the development of new theatre and performance; it allows for personal development and exploration. It allows both performer and designer the opportunity to stretch the limits of their creativity and imagination, while exploring a theme or topic of interest to them and their intended audience.

Students will develop skills in creative collaboration, research and negotiation, while also developing creativity, performance and design skills. Students will consider the impact that they can make on an audience, as they develop the ideas that they want to communicate.

Content

There are **three** areas of focus.

- 1) Creating and developing a devised piece from stimuli.
- 2) A performance/design realisation of the devised piece.
- 3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process for a devised performance.

Students may complete this component as part of a duologue performance (2 performers) or a group performance (3–6 performers). NB: The duologue performance option will be for first teaching September 2025, first assessment 2027.

Students may complete this component either as a performer or designer.

The design roles are:

- costume design
- lighting design
- set design
- sound design.

Centres wanting to offer design roles to students should refer to *Appendix 3: Design roles minimum resource requirements for centres*.

Choice of stimuli

Centres have a free choice of stimuli, but the stimuli must ensure that students can:

- work collaboratively to create and develop the performance
- apply the necessary performance or design skills
- analyse and evaluate both the process and the performance
- meet the Assessment Objectives.

Teachers should choose between 1–3 pieces of stimuli and these may be one or a combination of the following:

- textual, for example a novel, poem, story, letter or factual material
- visual, for example a painting, photograph, film or artefact
- aural, for example a piece of music, a soundscape or a recording
- abstract, for example a word, a theme or a mood.

Stimuli material should avoid any unnecessary offence to students – also please see *Appendix 5* for further guidance on selection. Stimuli material should:

- be age appropriate
- **not** cause, racial, religious or gender offence
- **not** include performance texts or recordings of live theatre.

Duologue / Group Requirements

Duologue time limits

A duologue must contain 2 performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per duologue.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that duologues must complete a minimum performance time of 3 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the duologue has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group sizes and time limits

A group must contain between **three** and **six** performance students. In addition, there can be up to one designer per role, per group.

All students must be assessed as individuals.

The regulatory requirements are that groups must complete a minimum performance time of 4 minutes for this component.

The recommended minimum performance times have been provided to ensure that each student within the group has sufficient time to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Group size	Recommended minimum performance times	Maximum performance times
2 performance students (duologue)	6 minutes	8 minutes
3–4 performance students (group)	10 minutes	15 minutes
5–6 performance students (group)	20 minutes	25 minutes

Centres should be aware that performance times that are between the regulatory minimum (4 minutes) and the recommended minimum (10 or 20 minutes) may not allow students to evidence their skills fully in order to access all levels of the assessment criteria.

Meeting the performance timings

Students (performance and design) who do not meet the regulatory minimum performance requirement of 4 minutes will be assessed by teachers against the assessment criteria on *pages 25-28*; however they will not be able to achieve beyond Level 2.

Teachers will be required to stop marking after the maximum performance time has passed.

Failure to accurately record the performance times on the authentication sheet (see *Appendix 1*) may result in staff/centre malpractice. For further information about this, please see the *Administration and general information* section in this specification.

1) Creating and developing a devised piece from stimuli

Students must select stimuli and then be able to demonstrate how they have been used to create and develop a performance piece, this should include how they have rehearsed and refined their work with clear intent. This process must be recorded over the course of the development from inception to performance.

Performers and designers must work collaboratively and keep an individual record of their contribution throughout the process.

Students are required to know and understand the following:

- characteristics of dramatic work including genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- how meaning is communicated and interpreted through:
 - performance conventions
 - use of space and spatial relationships on stage
 - relationships between performer and audience.

All students must explore the processes by which devised performance is developed and demonstrate the following skills to create and communicate meaning through:

- research
- developing ideas and intentions
- rehearsing, refining and amending work in progress for performance.

Centres **may** practically explore stimuli using a variety of methods such as:

- whole class exploration
- small group improvisations
- creating tableaux, role on the wall, hot seating, etc.
- developing movement/physical sequences
- developing soundscapes
- forum theatre.

Students' research **should** include (where relevant) an investigation of:

- social, historical and cultural contexts
- theatrical conventions
- current themes and trends
- issues and controversies.

The creative process should be done practically by students. Significant time should be spent developing and rehearsing the work for an audience. Students should also be aware of any relevant health and safety considerations.

2) Group/duologue-devised performances/design realisations

All students must contribute to the realisation of artistic intentions. They will demonstrate skills as a performer and/or designer in a performance for a live audience.

All performances must be recorded and centres are free to identify their own suitable audience and venue for the performance. This could include:

- performance to the rest of the class or another class within the centre
- performance to an invited external audience.

Performers must develop skills in:

- rehearsing and learning lines; adapting work in response to rehearsals (to be done collaboratively)
- voice: use of clarity, pace, inflection, pitch and projection
- physicality: use of space, gesture, stillness and stance
- ability to combine and apply vocal and physical skills
- characterisation
- communication with other performers and with the audience
- understanding of style, genre and theatrical conventions.

For design skills, please see section below.

Teachers should adopt a facilitating role in this component. They can give support and guidance at the development stage of the performance(s) but not during the performance(s).

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **allowed** to:

- help students with interpreting information, e.g. explaining assessment criteria and the requirements of the component
- intervene if a health and safety issue arises
- intervene if a risk to security of evidence arises
- undertake a management role in relation to managing time, space, resources
- ask questions to stimulate independent thought without leading students.

When in a facilitating role, teachers are **not allowed** to:

- offer coaching
- direct students
- undertake an artistic/creative role
- give solutions to artistic/creative problems
- make artistic/creative decisions.

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3) Analysing and evaluating the creative process and Group/duologue-devised performance

All students must reflect on and evaluate the effectiveness of the devising process. Students must analyse and evaluate:

- ideas explored and research undertaken
- decisions made and the rationale behind them
- their collaborative involvement
- content, genre, structure, character, form, style, and language
- the final performance and the effectiveness of their contribution to it
- the realisation of their intentions.

All students must also be aware of, and be able to use, appropriate subject-specific terminology.

Design roles

Designers must work collaboratively within a group of performers within their chosen area of design to realise artistic intentions. They must be aware of any relevant health and safety considerations.

Where a student is assessed in a design role, it is their design skill that is the focus of the assessment, rather than their technical competence in the operation or use of equipment.

The devised piece should provide sufficient opportunity for designers to meet the demands of this component. Designs should take into consideration performer/audience relationships and any health and safety implications and performer usage as appropriate.

There is a maximum of one designer per role, per group/duologue.

Designers must develop skills in:

- making appropriate judgements during the development process
- creating clear and practical design (e.g. creating plans/plots/diagrams/sketches) with consideration to practical application of materials and production elements
- adapting designs in response to rehearsals (to be done collaboratively)
- using visual/aural elements to create mood and atmosphere and style
- using, applying and combining design skills to contribute and support the performance as a whole
- demonstrating the ability to apply design skills effectively within the context of the performance
- communicating intention and creating impact to an audience.

There is a list of the requirements for each design skill for this component on the next page.